

HTC Touch*Touch Flo—no go***HTC Touch**

The first to utilise the touch flo concept that Apple used for the iPhone and the iPod Touch and quite frankly it wasn't as well implemented as we'd liked. Imitation is the best form of flattery, but only if it's well executed. Needless to say without any sort of keypad, and Touch Flo not working the same magic as it did for Apple, the HTC Touch is a flawed business device. It's well built however, and attractive as the silver menu button is the only relief from the matte black finish across the body. Based around WM 6.0 Pro the device is also slow, which doesn't help. Although voice clarity in-call isn't bad, the multimedia frills are just that—frills—mostly for show and hardly any go.

It's an old device too, and one we tested last year as well. At Rs 16,990 the Touch is no more novel than the concept of free home deliveries these days. Resist the urge to touch this one.

Palm Centro*Memoirs of a bygone era***Palm Centro**

The Centro is the only device actually based on a Palm OS, and is a refreshing change after all the WM devices floating around. It's a novel concept—create a neat, curvy phone, add a full QWERTY keypad and touchscreen and drop in a Palm OS—which has to be praised for the menu intuitiveness and layout, and transparency of settings. At 2.6 inches the screen is square and features a square resolution of 320 x 320 pixels which is good. A pity that the

QWERTY isn't well laid out, and although the keys have adequate gaps the keys themselves are small and difficult to use unless you're well accustomed to the keypad. At Rs 13,990 our only issue would be application support and the lack of a really usable keypad.

Nokia E51*Tiny, mighty*

When the E51 came out we were very impressed. Strong on paper specifications and a rugged phone that was sleek and stylish. A year has passed and the E51 is still

**Nokia E51**

charming, although not as hot as we once thought it to be, as countless clones have spawned that surpass its capabilities. The build quality is great, and the phone itself has been well designed. It's got a clear, crisp screen that does seem tiny in comparison to others (2 inches). It's rich in terms of connectivity options although its light on multimedia features. It targets the business user who wants something basic. It still makes a decent buy for someone looking for a good, feature rich phone, but at Rs 13,069 has lost the oomph factor.

BEST BUY
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**ASUS P320****ASUS P320***Small Warrior*

ASUS' P320 is a cute phone cum PDA, with a large menu button and little else on an attractive black fascia. It's very compact, much smaller than most PDAs, and sports a 2.6 inch touchscreen, which is great for such a compact device. Build quality is excellent and the fit and finish very good. Although the lack of any sort of keypad will detract from its appeal to hardcore PDA fans, we reckon this device is somewhat of a poster child for PDAs/smartphones in general.

WM 6.1 Pro makes its first official appearance in our test labs with this device and full office document creation and editing is supported (although the QWERTY is missed here). With full MS Outlook 2007 bundled, and useful applications like a business card scanner, and Voice Commander 2.0 the P320 is definitely loaded in terms of software. A 2 MP camera and integrated GPS means that the bundle is complete. It's got all the connectivity options (WiFi, Bluetooth etc), although HSCSD and 3G support are missing amongst communication standards. So a good phone, with good features. Shockingly, it's priced at just Rs 12,900, and that's MRP! At the price the P320s a steal, and if you have ever wanted a PDA cum smartphone this may be your best (and cheapest) bet to jump on to the bandwagon.

For The Discerning Corporate-types*PDA Phones Rs 20,000 And Above***Nokia E90 (Communicator)***The brick is back!*

Nokia has to offer at least one phone that can also double as a capable club-like weapon. Jokes aside their E90 is one heck of a capable device. It follows the classic Communicator design in being very much like a compass box, and will remind you of the E9500 and E9300. But under the hood lie an entire new set of innards. And the build quality is unmatched, as is the superb finish. The E90 has two screens—both are very high resolution and both feature 16 million colours. An autofocus 3.2 megapixel camera that actually offers superb quality may have you forgetting that this is essentially a PDA phone and not a teenagers dream gadget. The inner screen is an ultra wide 4 inches, although the phone becomes bulky as a result, and weighs a hefty 210 grams.

The number keypad is well laid out and very usable, and the E90 is very usable as a phone without ever opening the lid! The inner keypad is a QWERTY, and although the keys are well laid out and large enough, the feedback can only be described as clicky and hard to press—not something a corporate user typing out 20 mails a day really wants

**Nokia E90 (Communicator)**

to hear. And that's the E90s main clientele—the business user. There are seven Symbian shortcut keys available for speeding up regular corporate tasks. Although the outer joypad (D-pad in Nokia speak) works really well the inner one is clicky, which is our major gripe with the keypad and the phone in general. Going by the business users need to travel the E90 incorporates GPS as well.

Thanks to the high resolution inner screen (800 x 352 pixels) web browsing is a real treat, something of a novelty that we haven't seen since the *Imate Jasjar* days. As a business phone the E90 makes a lot of sense, although office document editing features are a little low as are the formatting options. In terms of office productivity Symbian is still not up to the mark for MS Windows based PDAs. Although application support for Symbian is rich, most of the business grade applications are still developed for the Windows Mobile platform, thanks to Microsoft's strong developer support programmes. However thanks to superb multimedia features the E90 gets a little more attractive. In fact attractive enough to recommend to the user who wants something to make a strong statement with. Although we cringe to think of the typical 18 year old college kid sporting an E90, because of the superb look, build quality, features and the sheer image of the Communicator series, this may well be possible. At Rs 40,139 the E90 asks for a lot. Serious business users will want to look at something more of a PDA, and less of a phone.

HTC Ty TN II*Comical name, top of its game*

The Ty TN II is a WM 6.0 based device that features a super high quality, matte black finish and a nice looking chromed set of joystick and call buttons. The front bezel is brushed metal which adds a classy, timeless dimension to the visual appeal of

**HTC Ty TN II**

a phone that already looks attractive. Fit and finish is superb. There's a side slide mechanism that reveals a full QWERTY keypad, that while being compact doesn't sacrifice on usability while offering good key feedback—emails will no longer be a pain. The Ty TN II features GPS, a 3.2 megapixel camera as well as all the usual necessities for a good PDA phone. It's a touchscreen phone as well, and the 2.8 inch screen is large enough for this purpose. The stylus works well, as do your fingers—thanks to the large shortcuts available in WM 6.0 Professional.

While using the QWERTY keypad the screen will even slide upwards to a more comfortable viewing incline, although it's this mechanism that bothers us—too many moving parts inside a heavily used device like a phone is never a good thing. Response in general is snappy and the never seems to run out of steam. As a PDA you get a full office suite, as well an infinite number of free applications available for the WM platform. It's a good phone too, with decent in-call clarity (which could improve), and handling a call itself is a snap courtesy the large menu buttons on the front bezel. Likewise SMS' and mails are a snap with the full keypad. Another plus is the quality of handsfree unit and other